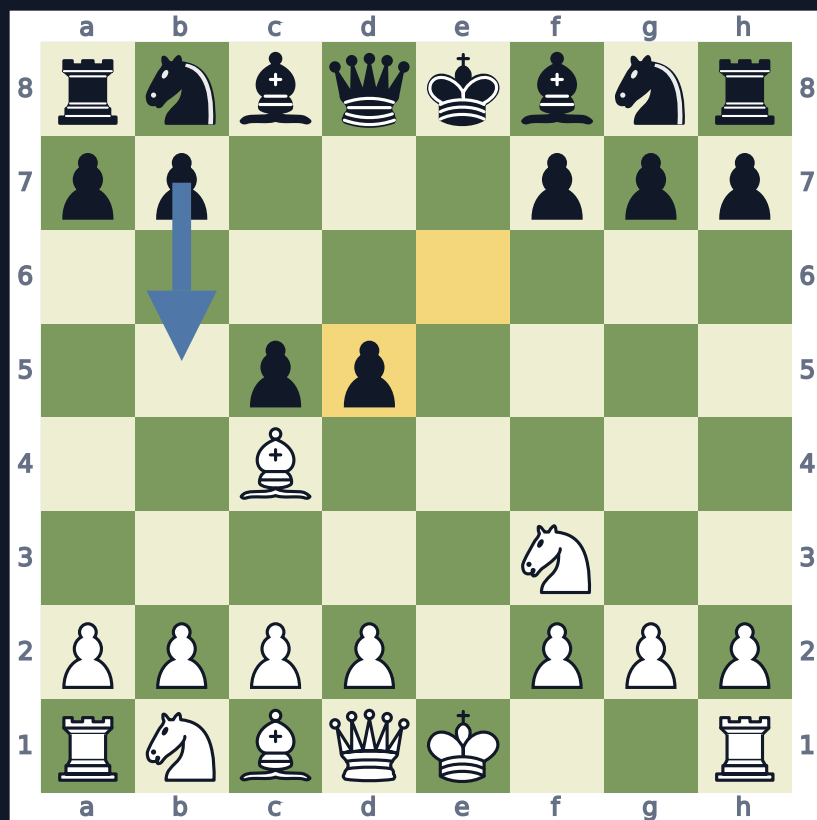


15

Rare Second Moves and Move-Order Traps

Bowdler, Wing Gambit, and delayed c3 systems: apply principles without walking into cheap tactics.



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

You will have a compact decision tree for uncommon systems and keep the game in sound Sicilian territory.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate Black's candidates, find White's strongest reply, and choose the resulting structure you understand. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 085 | PAGE 4

Decode: Bowdler bishop development*Punish an early bishop move by claiming the center, but calculate the checks.*

LESSON 086 | PAGE 8

Play: Bowdler bishop development*Punish an early bishop move by claiming the center, but calculate the checks.*

LESSON 087 | PAGE 12

Decode: Wing Gambit*Meet a wing gambit in the center and value time above pawns.*

LESSON 088 | PAGE 16

Play: Wing Gambit*Meet a wing gambit in the center and value time above pawns.*

LESSON 089 | PAGE 20

Decode: Delayed c3 and quiet development*Against a delayed center, preserve options and watch the break, not the opening label.*

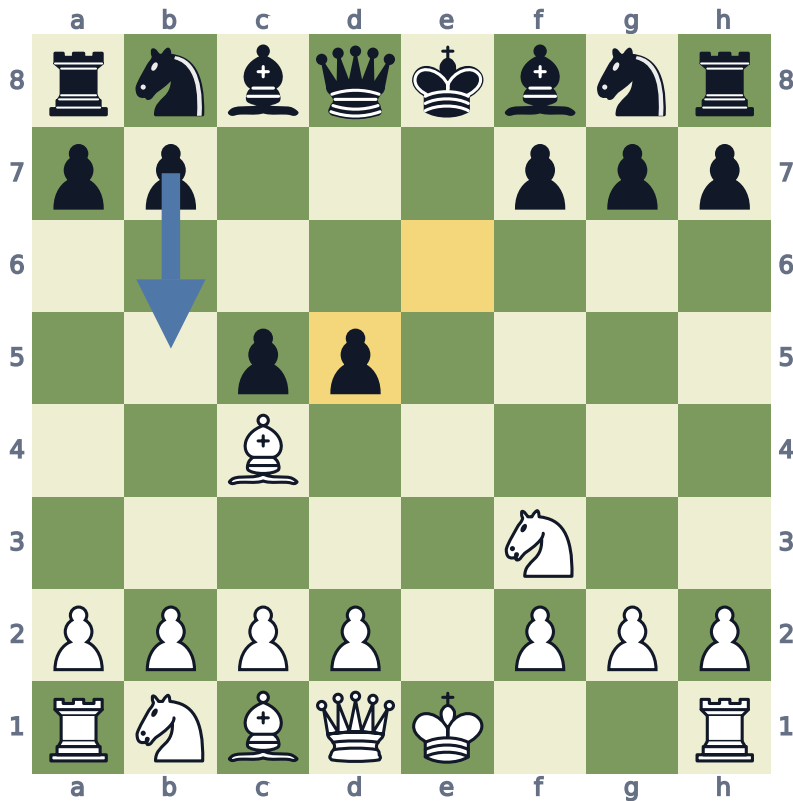
LESSON 090 | PAGE 24

Play: Delayed c3 and quiet development*Against a delayed center, preserve options and watch the break, not the opening label.***VOLUME OBJECTIVE**

You will have a compact decision tree for uncommon systems and keep the game in sound Sicilian territory.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Bowdler bishop development

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

Bc4 points at f7 but allows Black to challenge the center immediately because White has not prepared d4.

DECISION RULE

Can ...d5 be played without losing the pawn or exposing the king to a forcing check?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Use ...e6 and ...d5 to gain central equality while developing against checks and pins.

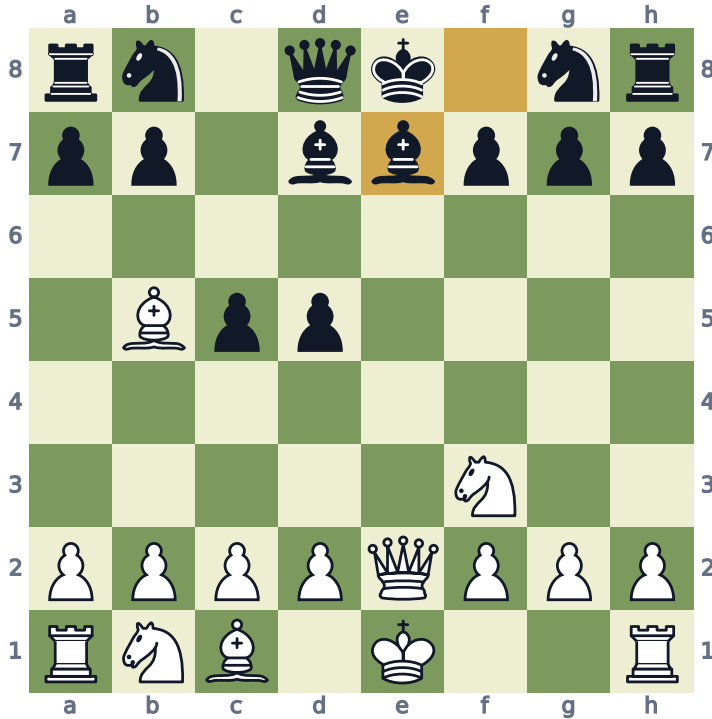
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White creates tactical pressure on d5 and f7 and may use Bb5+ to interrupt development.

MEMORY RULE | Punish an early bishop move by claiming the center, but calculate the checks.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Bc4 points at f7 but allows Black to challenge the center immediately because White has not prepared d4.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Use ...e6 and ...d5 to gain central equality while developing against checks and pins.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White creates tactical pressure on d5 and f7 and may use Bb5+ to interrupt development.

FAILURE MODE

Treating Bc4 as harmless and making a slow Sicilian move while White builds d4 for free.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Can ...d5 be played without losing the pawn or exposing the king to a forcing check? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

RULE | Punish an early bishop move by claiming the center, but calculate the checks.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Bc4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. exd5 exd5 5. Bb5+ Bd7 6. Qe2+ Be7



- Bc4: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- e6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Nf3: White reroutes a knight to f3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- d5: Black plays the freeing central break; its tactical soundness matters more than its thematic reputation.
- exd5: White releases tension by capturing on d5; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- exd5: Black releases tension by capturing on d5; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Bc4 points at f7 but allows Black to challenge the center immediately because White has not prepared d4.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Can ...d5 be played without losing the pawn or exposing the king to a forcing check? White's resistance is: White creates tactical pressure on d5 and f7 and may use Bb5+ to interrupt development. The line fails as a template when: Treating Bc4 as harmless and making a slow Sicilian move while White builds d4 for free.

STORE THIS | Punish an early bishop move by claiming the center, but calculate the checks.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

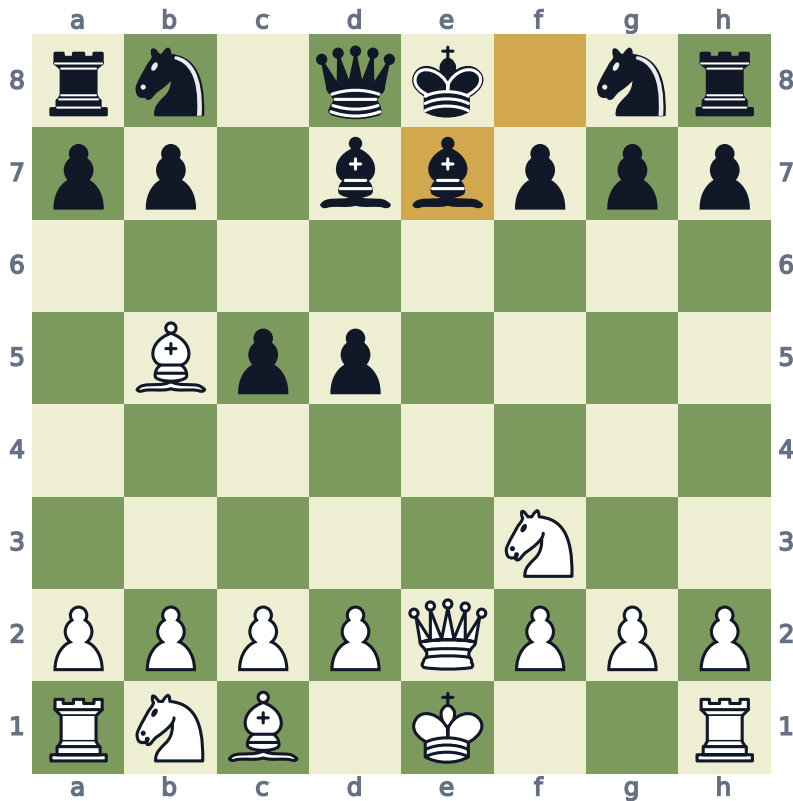
1. Bc4 points at f7 but allows Black to challenge the center immediately because White has not prepared d4. 2. Use ...e6 and ...d5 to gain central equality while developing against checks and pins. 3. White creates tactical pressure on d5 and f7 and may use Bb5+ to interrupt development. 4. Can ...d5 be played without losing the pawn or exposing the king to a forcing check? 5. Treating Bc4 as harmless and making a slow Sicilian move while White builds d4 for free.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 8 plies from memory, then replay: 2. Bc4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. exd5 exd5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Bowdler bishop development



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Bc4 points at f7 but allows Black to challenge the center immediately because White has not prepared d4.

DECISION RULE

Can ...d5 be played without losing the pawn or exposing the king to a forcing check?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Use ...e6 and ...d5 to gain central equality while developing against checks and pins.

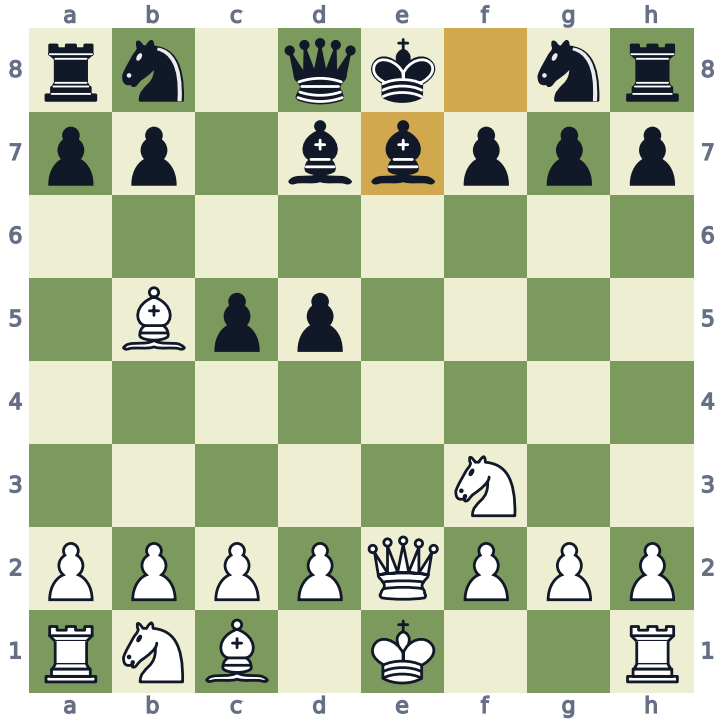
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White creates tactical pressure on d5 and f7 and may use Bb5+ to interrupt development.

MEMORY RULE | Punish an early bishop move by claiming the center, but calculate the checks.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Bc4 points at f7 but allows Black to challenge the center immediately because White has not prepared d4.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Use ...e6 and ...d5 to gain central equality while developing against checks and pins.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White creates tactical pressure on d5 and f7 and may use Bb5+ to interrupt development.

FAILURE MODE

Treating Bc4 as harmless and making a slow Sicilian move while White builds d4 for free.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Can ...d5 be played without losing the pawn or exposing the king to a forcing check? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

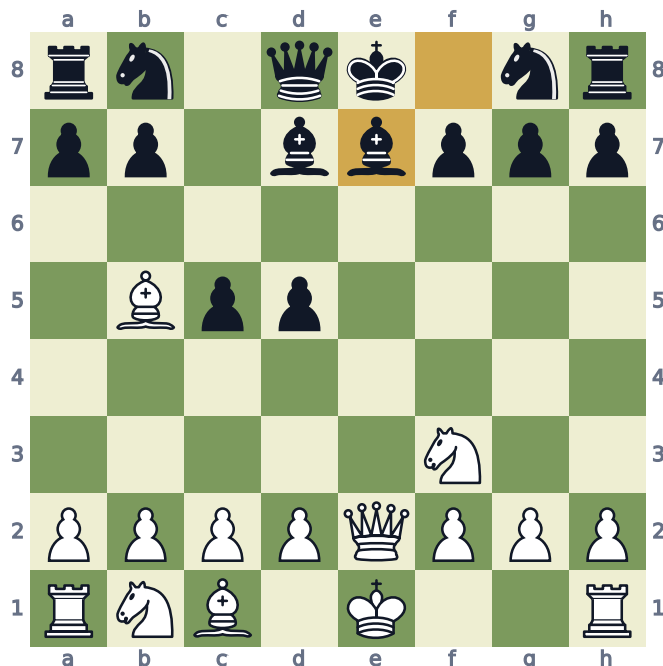
RULE | Punish an early bishop move by claiming the center, but calculate the checks.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Bc4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. exd5 exd5 5. Bb5+ Bd7 6. Qe2+ Be7



- exd5: White releases tension by capturing on d5; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- exd5: Black releases tension by capturing on d5; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Bb5+: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Bd7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Qe2+: White coordinates several plans, but the queen's safety and the opponent's forcing reply must be checked.
- Be7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Bc4 points at f7 but allows Black to challenge the center immediately because White has not prepared d4.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Can ...d5 be played without losing the pawn or exposing the king to a forcing check? White's resistance is: White creates tactical pressure on d5 and f7 and may use Bb5+ to interrupt development. The line fails as a template when: Treating Bc4 as harmless and making a slow Sicilian move while White builds d4 for free.

STORE THIS | Punish an early bishop move by claiming the center, but calculate the checks.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

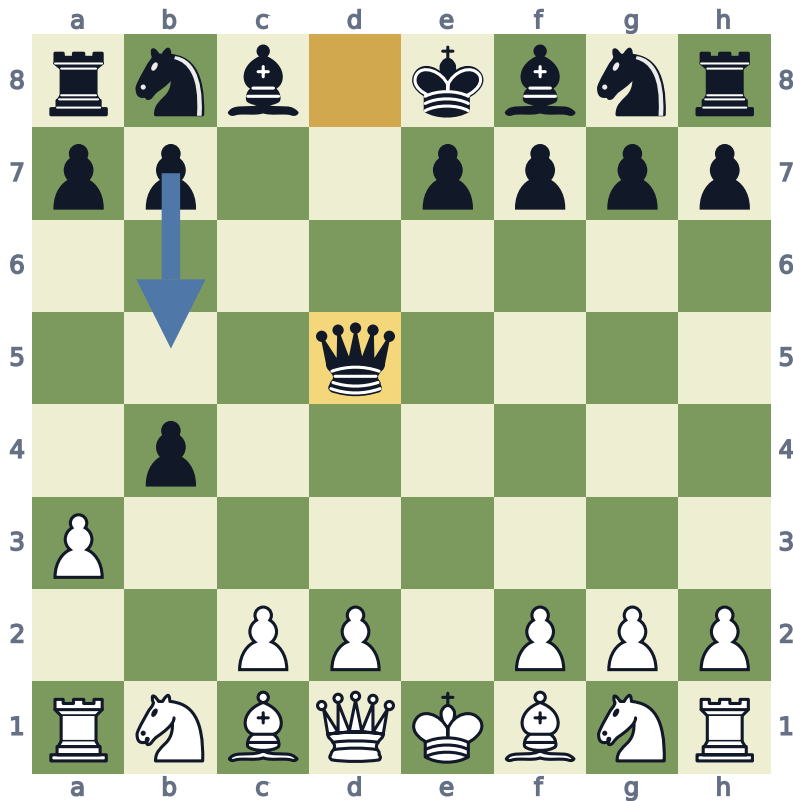
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. exd5 exd5 5. Bb5+ Bd7 6. Qe2+ Be7

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Wing Gambit

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

White sacrifices a wing pawn to distract c5 and gain central development; Black must avoid a greedy pawn-holding operation.

DECISION RULE

After accepting, what central move prevents White from building d4 with tempo?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Challenge the center with ...d5, return material if useful, and make the queen's development safe from tempi.

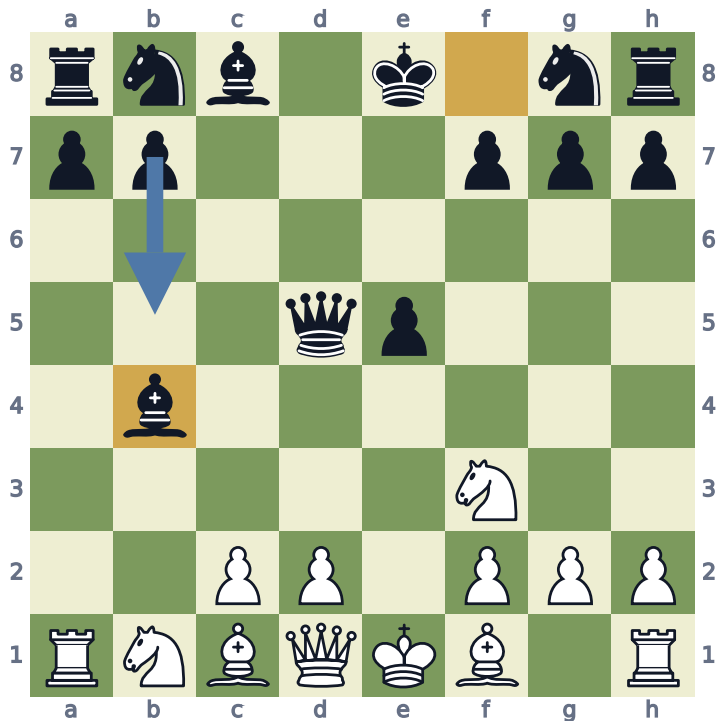
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White opens files, plays Nf3 and d4, and attacks the queen or uncastled king with rapid piece play.

MEMORY RULE | Meet a wing gambit in the center and value time above pawns.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

White sacrifices a wing pawn to distract c5 and gain central development; Black must avoid a greedy pawn-holding operation.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Challenge the center with ...d5, return material if useful, and make the queen's development safe from tempi.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White opens files, plays Nf3 and d4, and attacks the queen or uncastled king with rapid piece play.

FAILURE MODE

Protecting every extra pawn while White mobilizes all pieces.

DECISION TEST

Ask: After accepting, what central move prevents White from building d4 with tempo? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

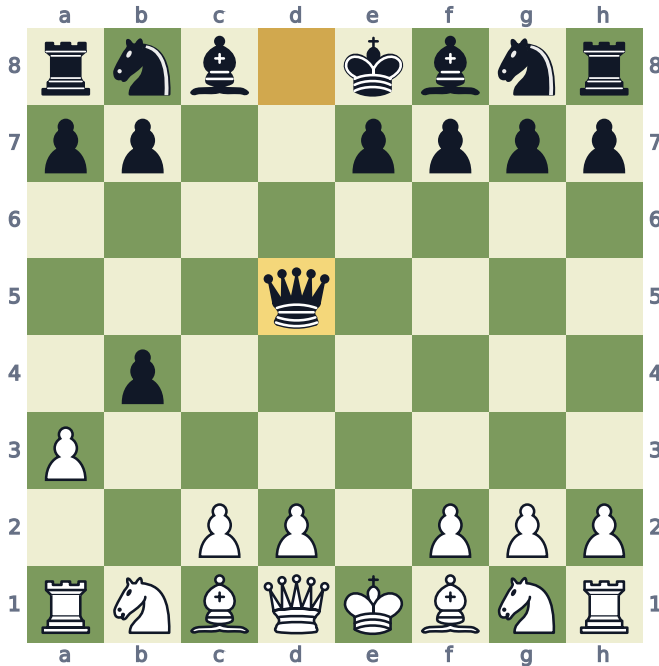
RULE | Meet a wing gambit in the center and value time above pawns.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. b4 cxb4 3. a3 d5 4. exd5 Qxd5 5. Nf3 e5 6. axb4 Bxb4



- b4: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- cxb4: Black releases tension by capturing on b4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- a3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- d5: Black plays the freeing central break; its tactical soundness matters more than its thematic reputation.
- exd5: White releases tension by capturing on d5; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Qxd5: Black releases tension by capturing on d5; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

White sacrifices a wing pawn to distract c5 and gain central development; Black must avoid a greedy pawn-holding operation.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

After accepting, what central move prevents White from building d4 with tempo? White's resistance is: White opens files, plays Nf3 and d4, and attacks the queen or uncastled king with rapid piece play. The line fails as a template when: Protecting every extra pawn while White mobilizes all pieces.

STORE THIS | Meet a wing gambit in the center and value time above pawns.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. White sacrifices a wing pawn to distract c5 and gain central development; Black must avoid a greedy pawn-holding operation. 2. Challenge the center with ...d5, return material if useful, and make the queen's development safe from tempi. 3. White opens files, plays Nf3 and d4, and attacks the queen or uncastled king with rapid piece play. 4. After accepting, what central move prevents White from building d4 with tempo? 5. Protecting every extra pawn while White mobilizes all pieces.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 8 plies from memory, then replay: 2. b4 cxb4 3. a3 d5 4. exd5 Qxd5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Wing Gambit



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

White sacrifices a wing pawn to distract c5 and gain central development; Black must avoid a greedy pawn-holding operation.

DECISION RULE

After accepting, what central move prevents White from building d4 with tempo?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Challenge the center with ...d5, return material if useful, and make the queen's development safe from tempi.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White opens files, plays Nf3 and d4, and attacks the queen or uncastled king with rapid piece play.

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CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

White sacrifices a wing pawn to distract c5 and gain central development; Black must avoid a greedy pawn-holding operation.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Challenge the center with ...d5, return material if useful, and make the queen's development safe from tempi.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White opens files, plays Nf3 and d4, and attacks the queen or uncastled king with rapid piece play.

FAILURE MODE

Protecting every extra pawn while White mobilizes all pieces.

DECISION TEST

Ask: After accepting, what central move prevents White from building d4 with tempo? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

RULE | Meet a wing gambit in the center and value time above pawns.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. b4 cxb4 3. a3 d5 4. exd5 Qxd5 5. Nf3 e5 6. axb4 Bxb4



- exd5: White releases tension by capturing on d5; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Qxd5: Black releases tension by capturing on d5; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Nf3: White reroutes a knight to f3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- e5: Black gains central space and a knight tempo while accepting a lasting weakness on d5.
- axb4: White releases tension by capturing on b4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Bxb4: Black releases tension by capturing on b4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

White sacrifices a wing pawn to distract c5 and gain central development; Black must avoid a greedy pawn-holding operation.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

After accepting, what central move prevents White from building d4 with tempo? White's resistance is: White opens files, plays Nf3 and d4, and attacks the queen or uncastled king with rapid piece play. The line fails as a template when: Protecting every extra pawn while White mobilizes all pieces.

STORE THIS | Meet a wing gambit in the center and value time above pawns.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. White sacrifices a wing pawn to distract c5 and gain central development; Black must avoid a greedy pawn-holding operation. 2. Challenge the center with ...d5, return material if useful, and make the queen's development safe from tempi. 3. White opens files, plays Nf3 and d4, and attacks the queen or uncastled king with rapid piece play. 4. After accepting, what central move prevents White from building d4 with tempo? 5. Protecting every extra pawn while White mobilizes all pieces.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. exd5 Qxd5 5. Nf3 e5 6. axb4 Bxb4

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Delayed c3 and quiet development



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

White delays d4 and may build a restrained center, hoping Black commits before the structure is clear.

DECISION RULE

Is White still preparing d4, and which black move makes that break less favorable?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Develop flexibly, keep ...d5 available, and do not force an Open Sicilian structure that White declined.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White prepares d4 under ideal conditions or keeps a King's Indian Attack shell for kingside play.

MEMORY RULE | Against a delayed center, preserve options and watch the break, not the opening label.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

White delays d4 and may build a restrained center, hoping Black commits before the structure is clear.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Develop flexibly, keep ...d5 available, and do not force an Open Sicilian structure that White declined.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White prepares d4 under ideal conditions or keeps a King's Indian Attack shell for kingside play.

FAILURE MODE

Expanding on the queenside before identifying whether the center will open.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Is White still preparing d4, and which black move makes that break less favorable? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

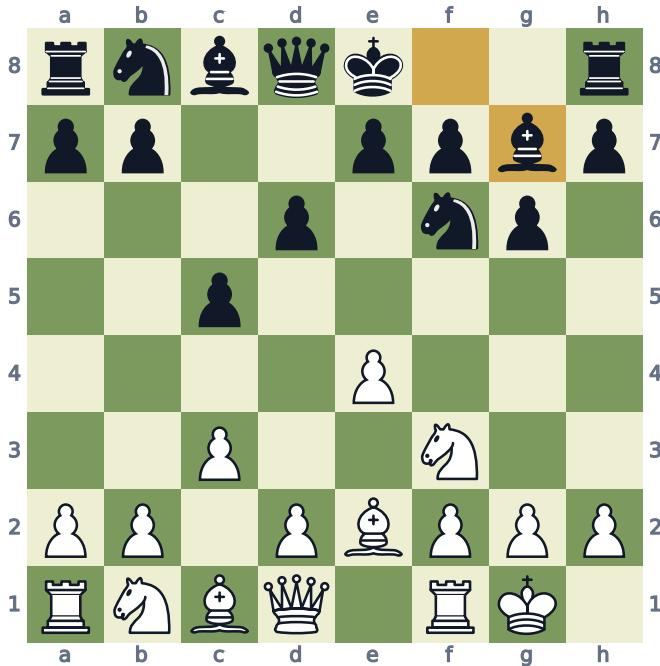
RULE | Against a delayed center, preserve options and watch the break, not the opening label.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. c3 Nf6 4. Be2 g6 5. O-O Bg7 6. d3 O-O 7. Re1 Nc6



- c3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight to f6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Be2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- g6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- Bg7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

White delays d4 and may build a restrained center, hoping Black commits before the structure is clear.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Is White still preparing d4, and which black move makes that break less favorable? White's resistance is: White prepares d4 under ideal conditions or keeps a King's Indian Attack shell for kingside play. The line fails as a template when: Expanding on the queenside before identifying whether the center will open.

STORE THIS | Against a delayed center, preserve options and watch the break, not the opening label.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

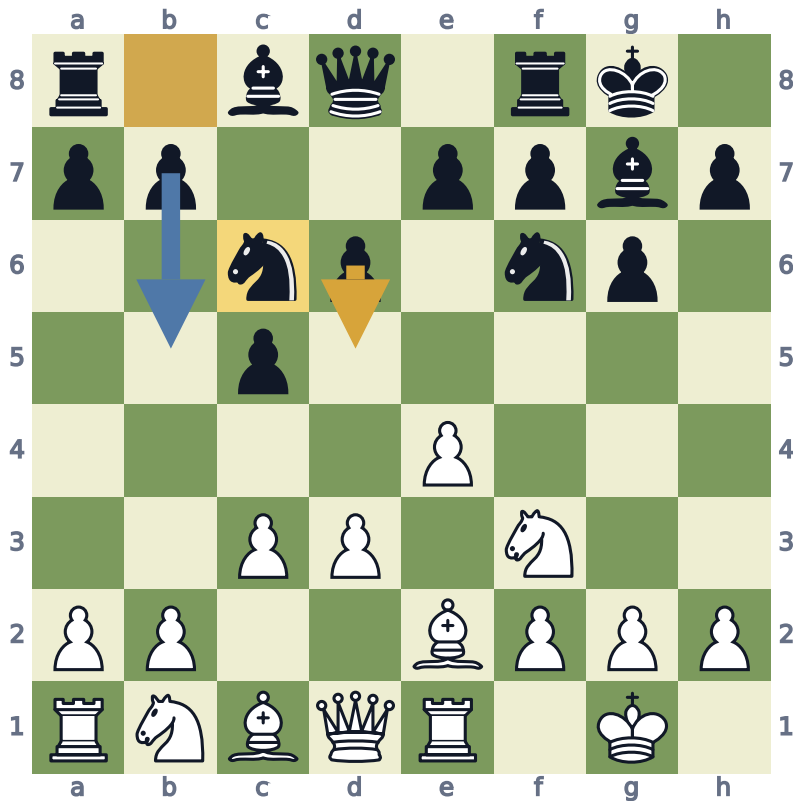
1. White delays d4 and may build a restrained center, hoping Black commits before the structure is clear. 2. Develop flexibly, keep ...d5 available, and do not force an Open Sicilian structure that White declined. 3. White prepares d4 under ideal conditions or keeps a King's Indian Attack shell for kingside play. 4. Is White still preparing d4, and which black move makes that break less favorable? 5. Expanding on the queenside before identifying whether the center will open.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 10 plies from memory, then replay: 3. c3 Nf6 4. Be2 g6 5. O-O Bg7

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Delayed c3 and quiet development



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

White delays d4 and may build a restrained center, hoping Black commits before the structure is clear.

DECISION RULE

Is White still preparing d4, and which black move makes that break less favorable?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Develop flexibly, keep ...d5 available, and do not force an Open Sicilian structure that White declined.

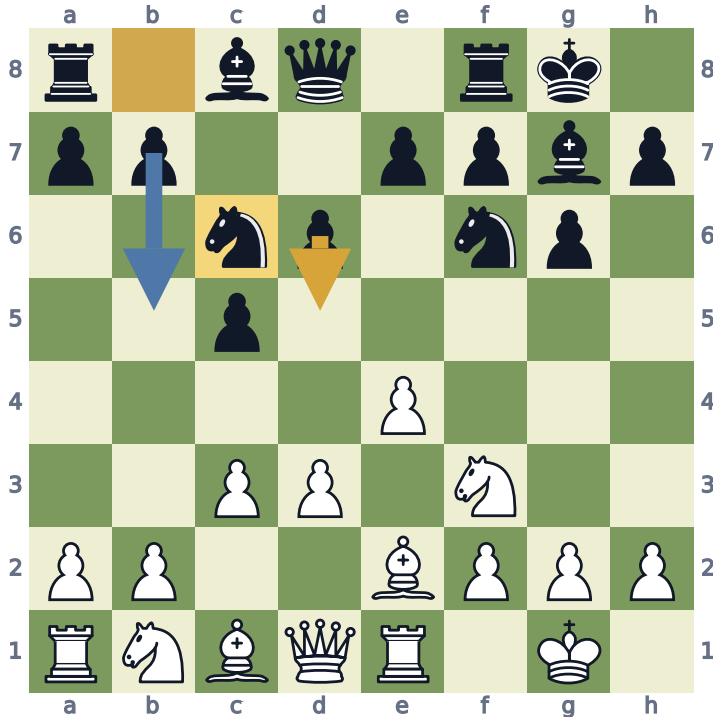
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White prepares d4 under ideal conditions or keeps a King's Indian Attack shell for kingside play.

MEMORY RULE | Against a delayed center, preserve options and watch the break, not the opening label.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

White delays d4 and may build a restrained center, hoping Black commits before the structure is clear.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Develop flexibly, keep ...d5 available, and do not force an Open Sicilian structure that White declined.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White prepares d4 under ideal conditions or keeps a King's Indian Attack shell for kingside play.

FAILURE MODE

Expanding on the queenside before identifying whether the center will open.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Is White still preparing d4, and which black move makes that break less favorable? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

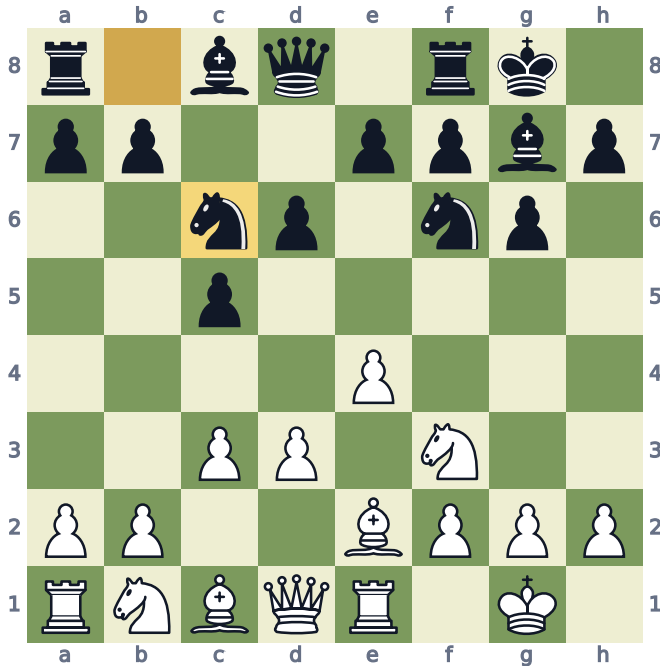
RULE | Against a delayed center, preserve options and watch the break, not the opening label.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. c3 Nf6 4. Be2 g6 5. O-O Bg7 6. d3 O-O 7. Re1 Nc6



- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- Bg7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- d3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- O-O: Black secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- Re1: White places a rook behind a file or pawn break expected to become important.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

White delays d4 and may build a restrained center, hoping Black commits before the structure is clear.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Is White still preparing d4, and which black move makes that break less favorable? White's resistance is: White prepares d4 under ideal conditions or keeps a King's Indian Attack shell for kingside play. The line fails as a template when: Expanding on the queenside before identifying whether the center will open.

STORE THIS | Against a delayed center, preserve options and watch the break, not the opening label.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. White delays d4 and may build a restrained center, hoping Black commits before the structure is clear. 2. Develop flexibly, keep ...d5 available, and do not force an Open Sicilian structure that White declined. 3. White prepares d4 under ideal conditions or keeps a King's Indian Attack shell for kingside play. 4. Is White still preparing d4, and which black move makes that break less favorable? 5. Expanding on the queenside before identifying whether the center will open.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 14 plies from memory, then replay: 5. O-O Bg7 6. d3 O-O 7. Re1 Nc6

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 085 Decode: Bowdler bishop development

Prompt: Can ...d5 be played without losing the pawn or exposing the king to a forcing check?

Recall: Punish an early bishop move by claiming the center, but calculate the checks.

LESSON 086 Play: Bowdler bishop development

Prompt: Can ...d5 be played without losing the pawn or exposing the king to a forcing check?

Recall: Punish an early bishop move by claiming the center, but calculate the checks.

LESSON 087 Decode: Wing Gambit

Prompt: After accepting, what central move prevents White from building d4 with tempo?

Recall: Meet a wing gambit in the center and value time above pawns.

LESSON 088 Play: Wing Gambit

Prompt: After accepting, what central move prevents White from building d4 with tempo?

Recall: Meet a wing gambit in the center and value time above pawns.

LESSON 089 Decode: Delayed c3 and quiet development

Prompt: Is White still preparing d4, and which black move makes that break less favorable?

Recall: Against a delayed center, preserve options and watch the break, not the opening label.

LESSON 090 Play: Delayed c3 and quiet development

Prompt: Is White still preparing d4, and which black move makes that break less favorable?

Recall: Against a delayed center, preserve options and watch the break, not the opening label.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's plan, White's counterplay, one candidate, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

Bowdler bishop development

1. e4 c5 2. Bc4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. exd5 exd5 5. Bb5+ Bd7 6. Qe2+ Be7

Decision: Can ...d5 be played without losing the pawn or exposing the king to a forcing check?

Memory: Punish an early bishop move by claiming the center, but calculate the checks.

CARD 2

Wing Gambit

1. e4 c5 2. b4 cxb4 3. a3 d5 4. exd5 Qxd5 5. Nf3 e5 6. axb4 Bxb4

Decision: After accepting, what central move prevents White from building d4 with tempo?

Memory: Meet a wing gambit in the center and value time above pawns.

CARD 3

Delayed c3 and quiet development

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. c3 Nf6 4. Be2 g6 5. O-O Bg7 6. d3 O-O 7. Re1 Nc6

Decision: Is White still preparing d4, and which black move makes that break less favorable?

Memory: Against a delayed center, preserve options and watch the break, not the opening label.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
085 Decode: Bowdler bishop development	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
086 Play: Bowdler bishop development	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
087 Decode: Wing Gambit	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
088 Play: Wing Gambit	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
089 Decode: Delayed c3 and quiet development	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
090 Play: Delayed c3 and quiet development	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name White's best counterplay, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.